Philosophy
Course Goals
What you'll need
Core Principles
Overview
Website & Materials
Questions?
Who are we?
Accountabilibuddies
My hope

Scientific Writing

IB 514

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Overview

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Course Goals

Primary Goal

To develop more effective and efficient writing skills.

Secondary Goal

To make significant progress on your manuscript.

What you'll need

"You must be ready to start writing a scientific manuscript the first week of the term. What does "be ready" mean? That's for you and your advisor(s) to decide.

That said, being ready does not mean being 100% done with your analyses or having all your final figures drafted. However, you do need to be far enough along to know what your paper's main story arc and primary message will be."

Core Principles

The 90-90 Rule

Doing the research is the first 90% of any project; writing it up is the other 90%.[1]

1. Being a scientist is being a writer
2. Productivity is designed, not discovered
3. Structure supercedes prose
4. Separate drafting from revising
5. Write for your readers
6. High-quality writing emerges from high-quality workflows
7. Literature is managed systematically
8. Collaboration is communication
9. Open science and reproducibility beget efficiency

[1] misquote of Tom Cargill of Bell Labs; see also Hofstadter's law.

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Schedule, Readings & Materials

https://github.com/marknovak/ScientificWriting/

What have I forgotten to tell you?

Who are we?

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- Preferred name
- Department
- What you study
- Fun fact about yourself
- Why you're here

Accountabilibuddies

- Weekly check-in
  - *Goals/deadlines, accomplishments, sticking-points*
  - *First 5-10 min. of every Wednesday*
- Randomized pairing
  - *re-randomized week 6 (if desired)*

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We're all learning...

Be kind to yourself.
Support each other.

Integrity

Doing the right thing, even when no one is watching.

Let's get started!

`.../classes/ProjectProposal`